UNIVERSITY OF SINDH

JAMSHORO, SINDH—PAKISTAN

Course No. EFMP-304 BED-4 Year

Title of Course **Critical Thinking & Reflective Practices** Credit Hours **3**

Semester 2nd

Reflection is a fundamental component of professional growth and pedagogical effectiveness in teaching. Effective teachers engage in critical thinking to systematically examine their instructional practices, evaluate classroom experiences, and make informed, evidence-based decisions to improve teaching and learning outcomes. Through reflective inquiry, teachers develop greater self-awareness, instructional adaptability, and problem-solving capacity, enabling them to respond effectively to diverse learners' needs.

This course engages prospective secondary school teachers in developing critical thinking skills and reflective practices through both theory and application. It equips student-teachers with the knowledge, dispositions, and skills required to critically analyze teaching and learning situations, reflect on their own and students' learning challenges, and identify appropriate solutions. Emphasis is placed on reflective models, experiential learning, and the use of reflective journals to foster lifelong professional learning.

By the end of this course, Student- teachers will be able to:

- Demonstrate the attributes of critical thinkers and reflective practitioners in professional teaching contexts.
- Analyze and evaluate arguments related to teaching and learning using recognized critical thinking standards and logical reasoning skills.
- Explain and justify the role and significance of reflective practice in enhancing teaching effectiveness at the secondary school level.
- Identify, compare, and evaluate established models and cyclical frameworks of reflective practice.
- Apply reflective strategies and evidence-based practices to enhance instructional decision-making and classroom effectiveness.
- Develop and maintain reflective journals to support metacognitive awareness, personal growth, and continuous professional development.

Unit 1: Understanding Critical Thinking
1.1 Introduction to Thinking as a Skill. Various functions of thought.
1.2 What is Critical Thinking?
1.3 Critical Thinking Standards
1.4 The Benefits of Critical Thinking in in Classroom, Workplace and Life.
1.5 Barriers to Critical Thinking
1.6 The Basic of Critical Thinking: Statements, Claims, Issues and Arguments
1.7 Characteristics of a Critical Thinker
1.8 Teachers as Critical Thinkers
Unit 2: Recognizing and Analyzing Arguments
2.1 Argument vs Explanation. Classical form of an Argument 2.2. Rhetoric Triangle, Issue and Information questions. 2.3 Types of Argument. 2.4 Identifying Premises and Conclusions. 2.5 What is NOT an Argument?
Unit 3: Basic Logic Concepts and Analyzing the Argument
3.1 Distinguishing between Deductive and Inductive arguments 3.2 Common Patterns of Deductive Reasoning 3.3 Common Patterns of Inductive Reasoning 3.4 Deductive Validity and Inductive Strength
Unit 4: Becoming a Reflective Teacher

4.1 Reflective Thinking, Reflective Process, Reflective Practice 4.2 Importance of Reflective Practice. Why should we do it? 4.3 Process of Reflective Practice - How should we do it? 4.4 Types of Reflection 4.5 Activities that Promoting Reflection
Unit 5: Engaging in Reflective Practice
5.1 Reflective Practice as Experiential Learning 5.2 The Cycle of Reflective Practice 5.3 Theoretical aspect of reflection 5.4 Knowing ourselves as a practitioner 5.4 Frameworks/Models for Reflection
Unit 6: Creating and Maintaining Reflective Journals
6.1 The Use of Reflective Journals 6.2 How to create and maintain a reflective journal 6.3 Writing to Reflect on Teaching 6.4 Some Prompts for Reflective Journal 6.5 Concluding the course
Text Books and References
• Bassham, G., Irwin, W., Nardone, H., & Wallace, J. M. (2010). *Critical thinking: A student's introduction*. McGraw-Hill. • Jasper, M. (2003). *Beginning reflective practice*. Nelson Thornes. • Boud, D., Keogh, R., & Walker, D. (2013). *Reflection: Turning experience into learning*. Routledge. • Pendrey, A. (2022). *The little book of reflective practice: A practical guide to the early years*. Routledge. • Brookfield, S. D. (2017). *Becoming a critically reflective teacher*. John Wiley & Sons. • Osterman, K. F., & Kottkamp, R. B. (2004). Reflective Practice for Educators. Thousand Oaks, CA: Crown. • Taggart, G. L., & Wilson, A. P. (2005). Promoting Reflective Thinking in Teachers. Thousand Oaks, CA: Crown

PROPOSED ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

Attendance:	10 marks
02 Assignments:	10 marks
Reflection file:	10 marks
Mid-Term:	30 marks
Final Term:	40 marks
Total:	**100 marks**